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RESEARCH FIELDS	Behavioral and Experimental Economics	
CURRENT POSITION	Research Assistant Chair of Applied Microeconomics (Prof. Dr. Ferdinand von Siemens) Goethe University Frankfurt	2021 –
AFFILIATIONS	Frankfurt Laboratory for Experimental Economic Research (FLEX)	2021 –
EDUCATION	Goethe University Frankfurt Ph.D. in Economics M.Sc. in Quantitative Economics	(Expected) 2026 2025
	Jacobs University Bremen B.A. in International Business Administration (Minor in Industrial Engineering and Management)	2019
	Rice University Visiting Undergraduate	2018
WORKING PAPERS	Stereotypes and Memory (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung) Imperfect memory can sustain widely held stereotypes that are inaccurate. To establish causal evidence, we conduct an online experiment where subjects grade a gender-stereotyped quiz for a class of students and later predict their performances on a similar quiz. We vary (1) reliance on memory by manipulating access to grading records and (2) the class with different gender performance gap. We find that stereotypes – perceived gender performance gaps – persist more when subjects rely on memory, but only when the true performance contradicts stereotypes. This result holds only for group-level, but not for individual-level assessments. Then, we extend the standard Bayesian framework with imperfect memory and find evidence of <i>memory attenuation</i> : reliance on memory substantially reduces how accurately individuals incorporate previously observed performance into their beliefs.	
	Communication and the Polarization of Trust Attitudes (with Ferdinand von Siemens) Given the critical role of generalized trust in the functioning of both public and private organizations, it is important to better understand the factors driving the substantial differences in trust across states, regions, and organizations. Group polarization theory suggests that communication might foster consensus within, while increasing differences across social groups. To test this argument, we conduct an online experiment in which some participants communicate before playing separate trust games. Participants only communicate with other participants in the same role – trustors talk with other trustors. Our results show that communication reduces the variation in trust within, while increasing trust differences between the chat groups, thus leading to a polarization of trust cultures. We further find that groups that develop strong positive trust cultures focus in their discussions on both moral principles and self-interest.	

WORK IN
PROGRESS

Misleading Graphs

Graphs often enhance comprehension of statistical evidence, yet certain design choices can backfire. This paper studies how visual contrast shapes belief updating when the underlying statistics are held fixed. I run an online experiment that randomizes how the same signal diagnosticity is communicated: Numbers, standard bar charts, or bar charts with truncated y-axes. Across a series of belief-updating tasks, truncated graphs shift posterior beliefs toward more extreme values, increase overreaction, and can induce updating in the wrong direction. To interpret these patterns, I develop a model in which individuals first form a mental representation of signal strength based on visual contrast, and then update beliefs based on this represented signal under cognitive imprecision. The model links contrast-induced distortions at the representation stage to predictable miscalibration in posteriors. The findings imply that seemingly innocuous visualization choices can generate systematic inference errors even in neutral domains.

GRANTS AND
AWARDS

The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences	
Co-PI (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung), research grant — 128,272 SEK	2025
Goethe University Frankfurt	
Research grant (VFF Förderung) — 800 EUR	2025
Research grant (Forschungstopf) — 3,200 EUR	2025
Travel grant (Forschungstopf)	2024
Research grant (Forschungstopf) — 3,240 EUR	2023
Research grant (VFF Förderung) — 800 EUR	2023
The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE	
Co-PI (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung), research grant — 3,000 EUR	2024
Jacobs University Bremen	
Study Abroad Scholarship	2018

SEMINAR AND
CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS
(INCLUDING
SCHEDULED)

2026

Conferences:

Workshop on Dynamic Decision Making: Minds, Models, and Markets (Sydney)
Economic Science Association Asia-Pacific Meeting (Melbourne)
The Fourth Wuhan Cherry Blossom Workshop on Experimental Economics (Wuhan)

2025

Conferences:

17th Nordic Conference in Behavioral and Experimental Economics (Stavanger)
Science of Decision Making Conference (Chengdu)
Behavioral, Experimental and Theoretical Economics Conference (Beijing)
Economic Science Association World Meeting (Beijing)
Young Economists' Meeting (Brno)

Seminars:

Jinan University (Guangzhou)
Central University of Finance and Economics (Beijing)

2024

Conferences:

Verona Experimental Meeting (Verona)
13th Southern Europe Experimental Team's Meeting (Málaga)

TEACHING	Goethe University Frankfurt	
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	
	- Fundamentals of Microeconomics (M.Sc.) - Behavioral Organizational Economics (B.Sc. Seminar) - The Economics of Social Media (M.Sc. Seminar) - Microeconomics 2 (B.Sc.) - Decision Making in Markets and Organizations (B.Sc.) - Organizational Economics (M.Sc.) - Advanced Topics in Experimental Organizational Economics (M.Sc. Seminar)	Winter 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025 Winter 2025 Winter 2022, 2023, 2024 Summer 2024 Summer 2023 Summer 2021, 2022 Winter 2021
	<i>Thesis Supervisor</i>	
	- Bachelor Thesis (15) - Master Thesis (10)	
PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES	Applied Microeconomics and Organization Seminar Co-organizer, Goethe University Frankfurt	2023 –
	Management and Microeconomics Brown Bag Seminar Organizer, Goethe University Frankfurt	2022 –
	Annual Meeting of the Committee for Organizational Economics Co-organizer, Frankfurt	2022
TECHNICAL SKILLS	L ^A T _E X, ORSEE, oTree, Python, Stata	
LANGUAGES	English (fluent), Chinese (native), German (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate)	
PERSONAL INFORMATION	Born in 1999 Citizenship: Chinese, German permanent resident (Niederlassungserlaubnis)	
REFERENCES	Ferdinand von Siemens (Main advisor) Goethe University Frankfurt Theodor-W.-Adorno-Platz 4 60323 Frankfurt am Main vonsiemens@econ.uni-frankfurt.de	Frederik Schwerter Frankfurt School of Finance and Management Adickesallee 32-34 60322 Frankfurt am Main f.schwerter@fs.de
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